Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**Theatre**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	How does 'Soldaat van Oranje – De Musical' use scenography to evoke the feeling of Dutch national unity and pride among the audience?		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**6**	The question has a clear, dramaturgical focus, inviting a critical evaluation of production values in a particular live theatre performance. Research methodology is robust and tailored to the specific topic. The research methods are explained and applied effectively; the analysis of primary source material is integrated with disciplined research informed by scholarly methods. A well-reasoned response to the question has been constructed; research findings are effectively communicated. Sources – including experiential research – are fully referenced in the list of works cited.	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	The candidate demonstrates knowledge of and engages with the production's relevant national and historical context, supported by the effective application of appropriate research. First-hand observations are detailed and perceptive. Some relevant theatre terminology is used accurately and with understanding. The candidate explains and effectively demonstrates conceptual understanding of scenography as an active agent of dramaturgy to convey meaning.	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**6**	An argument is carefully developed, with informed analysis of visual semiotics and other findings supported by personal observations and relevant secondary research. The candidate builds a compelling academic argument; a coherent thread links explanations, arguments and research findings, and – despite the introduction of some new arguments - results in a convincing summative conclusion.	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**5**	The discussion provides a balanced review of the significance of research findings. On the other hand, there is uneven support for the candidate's own interpretation of audience impact and directorial intentions. Although the candidate does critically evaluate scenic design, there is no appraisal of the strengths or limitations of research.	
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**4**	The reflective statement is consistently evaluative, offering specific examples of how insights gained and skills developed could be used in other contexts. The candidate reflects on how the EE experience changed their perspective, both personally and as an audience member, and impacted their ability to structure and support an argument, demonstrating evidence of growth.	
Total marks awarded	**26/30**		
Holistic comment on the essay:	The investigation is focused and well-structured, and - although the candidate does not assesses the quality of their research - arguments and critical		

	evaluations of elements of scenic design are born of intellectual engagement with the production's historical context.